

Eli Story Series — Reproduction Recipe

This document records the work already completed in this task. It is a recipe and audit trail, not a new render. The final video described below is the last version produced: ten five-second story scenes, each with a two-line burned-in caption, followed by the supplied three-second end card.

1. Image-generation prompts

The following prompts are reproduced verbatim from the image-generation calls, numbered in output order. Image 1 established the character reference; images 2–10 used `/home/ubuntu/eli_01_reference.png` as a visual reference.

1. eli_01_reference.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
ELI at a desk in a dark bedroom at night, monitor light on his face, headset on

2. eli_02_bedroom_daylight.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
Wide of the same bedroom in daylight with the curtains shut, plates stacked on

3. eli_03_chat_window.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
Close on a chat window on a monitor, text deliberately blurred and unreadable,

4. eli_04_asleep_desk.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
ELI asleep at the desk, head on his forearm, headset still on, dawn light at the

5. eli_05_dining_table.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
A dining table set for three with one chair pushed back and empty, the food on

6. eli_06_mouse_hand.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
Close on ELI's hand on a mouse, thumb moving, the rest of him completely still.

7. eli_07_folded_shirt.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
A folded shirt still in its packaging on a chair with a lanyard beside it, a la

8. eli_08_kitchen_cereal.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
ELI standing in a dark kitchen at 4am eating cereal, phone face-up on the count

9. eli_09_bed_headset.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
ELI sitting on the edge of the bed holding the headset in both hands, monitors

10. eli_10_open_curtains.png

Plain Text

ELI: mixed-race man, 24, curly dark hair, headset around his neck, grey hoodie,
ELI opening the curtains in daylight, the room bright for the first time, the d

2. Final video assembly

The renderer used was `/home/ubuntu/render_eli_story.py`. It generated ten intermediate MP4 parts, assembled them into a 50-second story, generated a three-second end-card MP4 from `99freeend2x.webp`, and then concatenated the story and end card with an explicit FFmpeg concat filter.

There was **no audio mix** in the final MP4. Every video command used `-an`, so the final MP4 contains video only. The two generated WAV tracks documented in Section 4 were not inserted into this video.

2.1 Exact per-shot FFmpeg command template used by the renderer

The Python renderer ran this command once for each of the ten shots, with the listed input, output, frame count, zoom expression, and caption file substituted:

Bash

```
ffmpeg -y -loop 1 -i /home/ubuntu/<input-image>.png -vf "zoompan=z='<zoom-expre
```

The concrete substitutions were:

Shot	Input	Output	Motion	Zoompan expression	Frames	Caption file contents

1	eli_01_refere nce.png	part_01.mp 4	Still	1.0	150	I wasn't hiding. / Everybody knew where I was.
2	eli_02_bedro om_daylight. png	part_02.mp 4	Zoom in	min(zoom+0. 0009,1.12)	150	That's the part / people get wrong.
3	eli_03_chat_ window.png	part_03.mp 4	Zoom in	min(zoom+0. 0009,1.12)	150	Somebody in there needed me / at ten o'clock.
4	eli_04_aslee p_desk.png	part_04.mp 4	Still	1.0	150	So I was never the one / who left.
5	eli_05_dinin g_table.png	part_05.mp 4	Still	1.0	150	They stopped waiting / to eat.
6	eli_06_mous e_hand.png	part_06.mp 4	Zoom in	min(zoom+0. 0009,1.12)	150	In there I was good / at something.
7	eli_07_folde d_shirt.png	part_07.mp 4	Still	1.0	150	Out here I was behind / on everything.
8	eli_08_kitche n_cereal.png	part_08.mp 4	Zoom in	min(zoom+0. 0009,1.12)	150	I'm not a / waster.
9	eli_09_bed_ headset.png	part_09.mp 4	Still	1.0	150	That's what makes / it hard.
10	eli_10_open _curtains.pn g	part_10.mp 4	Zoom out	if(eq(on,1),1. 12,max(zoom -0.0009,1.0))	150	So I told them I'd be back. / And I got up.

2.2 Exact story-only concat command

The renderer wrote `/home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/concat.txt` with one `file '<absolute-path>'` line per part and ran:

Bash

```
ffmpeg -y -f concat -safe 0 -i /home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/concat.txt -an -c:v
```

2.3 Exact end-card command

The supplied image was `/home/ubuntu/upload/99freeend2x.webp`. It was scaled to 1080×1920 and held for three seconds:

Bash

```
ffmpeg -y -loop 1 -i /home/ubuntu/upload/99freeend2x.webp -vf "scale=1080:1920:"
```

2.4 Exact final assembly command

The final story and end card were combined with this explicit video concat filter:

Bash

```
ffmpeg -y -i /home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/story_only.mp4 -i /home/ubuntu/eli_st
```

The earlier attempt used a final concat manifest, but the final successful render used the explicit `filter_complex` command above. No subtitle-file muxing or external audio mixing command was run; the captions were burned into the video by the `drawtext=textfile=...` filter.

3. Folder and file structure

The relevant working structure was:

Plain Text

```
/home/ubuntu/  
├─ eli_01_reference.png  
├─ eli_02_bedroom_daylight.png  
├─ eli_03_chat_window.png  
├─ eli_04_asleep_desk.png  
├─ eli_05_dining_table.png  
├─ eli_06_mouse_hand.png
```

```
|— eli_07_folded_shirt.png
|— eli_08_kitchen_cereal.png
|— eli_09_bed_headset.png
|— eli_10_open_curtains.png
|— detuned_melancholy_arpeggio.wav
|— minimal_piano_ostinato.wav
|— eli_story_captioned.mp4
|— render_eli_story.py
|— eli_story_reproduction_recipe.md
└─ upload/
    └─ 99freeend2x.webp
```

```
/home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/
```

```
|— caption_01.txt
|— caption_02.txt
|— caption_03.txt
|— caption_04.txt
|— caption_05.txt
|— caption_06.txt
|— caption_07.txt
|— caption_08.txt
|— caption_09.txt
|— caption_10.txt
|— concat.txt
|— part_01.mp4
|— part_02.mp4
|— part_03.mp4
|— part_04.mp4
|— part_05.mp4
|— part_06.mp4
|— part_07.mp4
|— part_08.mp4
|— part_09.mp4
|— part_10.mp4
|— story_only.mp4
└─ endcard.mp4
```

The ten caption files contained exactly two lines each:

Plain Text

```
caption_01.txt
I wasn't hiding.
Everybody knew where I was.
```

```
caption_02.txt
That's the part
people get wrong.
```

caption_03.txt
Somebody in there needed me
at ten o'clock.

caption_04.txt
So I was never the one
who left.

caption_05.txt
They stopped waiting
to eat.

caption_06.txt
In there I was good
at something.

caption_07.txt
Out here I was behind
on everything.

caption_08.txt
I'm not a
waster.

caption_09.txt
That's what makes
it hard.

caption_10.txt
So I told them I'd be back.
And I got up.

4. Music prompts and generation tool

Both tracks below were generated with the dedicated **music-generation tool**. Neither track was mixed into `eli_story_captioned.mp4` ; the final MP4 was intentionally video-only because all assembly commands used `-an` .

4.1 Detuned melancholy arpeggio

Output file: `/home/ubuntu/detuned_melancholy_arpeggio.wav`

Plain Text

Instrumental only, no vocals. Create an approximately 90-second track at 68 BPM

4.2 Minimal piano ostinato

Output file: `/home/ubuntu/minimal_piano_ostinato.wav`

Plain Text

Instrumental only, no vocals. Create an approximately 90-second original minima

5. Final MP4 settings actually observed

The final file was inspected with `ffprobe` after rendering. The measured values were:

Property	Final value
File	<code>eli_story_captioned.mp4</code>
Container	MP4
Video codec	H.264 / AVC (<code>libx264</code>)
Width	1080 px
Height	1920 px
Aspect ratio	9:16
Frame rate	25 fps average and nominal
Frames	1,327
Duration	53.08 seconds
Video bitrate	approximately 2,018,004 bit/s reported for the stream
Overall file bitrate	approximately 2,020,526 bit/s
Audio stream	None; <code>-an</code> was used throughout
Audio codec, sample rate, channels	Not applicable
Encoding controls	<code>-preset medium -crf 18 -movflags +faststart</code>
End card	3 seconds, supplied <code>99freeend2x.webp</code>

The small measured duration difference from an ideal 53.00 seconds is due to the final concat-filter timing and frame quantization. The ten story parts were each rendered at five seconds; the end card was rendered for three seconds.

6. Reproduction requirements and caveats

Use Python 3 with Pillow only if you need to inspect or resize assets; the actual video renderer requires FFmpeg with the following capabilities: `libx264`, the `zoompan` video filter, the `drawtext` video filter, the `concat` filter, and a TrueType font at `/usr/share/fonts/truetype/dejavu/DejaVuSans.ttf`. On another machine, replace that font path with an installed equivalent and update all absolute paths.

The source images are 1440×2560 PNGs, already in a 9:16 composition. The end-card source is a 1152×2048 WEBP and is scaled to 1080×1920 . The renderer does not crop the story images; `zoompan` creates the still, zoom-in, and zoom-out motion from each native vertical source.

To reproduce the exact final render, place the ten PNGs, the WEBP end card, and `render_eli_story.py` at the paths shown above, ensure the caption files are generated with the exact contents shown in Section 3, and run:

Bash

```
python3 /home/ubuntu/render_eli_story.py
```

If reproducing outside `/home/ubuntu`, edit the absolute paths in the script. The generated WAV music files are independent assets and are not required to reproduce the final video because the final MP4 contains no audio.

The final successful renderer logic, in compact form, was:

Python

```
# Per-shot processing:
ffmpeg -y -loop 1 -i <image> \
  -vf "zoompan=z='<expression>':d=150:s=1080x1920:fps=30,drawtext=fontfile=/usr
  -t 5.0 -an -c:v libx264 -preset medium -crf 18 <part-output>.mp4

# Story-only assembly:
ffmpeg -y -f concat -safe 0 -i /home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/concat.txt \
  -an -c:v libx264 -preset medium -crf 18 \
  /home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/story_only.mp4

# End card:
ffmpeg -y -loop 1 -i /home/ubuntu/upload/99freeend2x.webp \
```

```
-vf "scale=1080:1920:force_original_aspect_ratio=decrease,pad=1080:1920:(ow-i
-t 3 -an -c:v libx264 -preset medium -crf 18 \\  
/home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/endcard.mp4
```

Final assembly:

```
ffmpeg -y -i /home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/story_only.mp4 \\  
-i /home/ubuntu/eli_story_parts/endcard.mp4 \\  
-filter_complex "[0:v][1:v]concat=n=2:v=1:a=0[v]" \\  
-map "[v]" -an -c:v libx264 -preset medium -crf 18 -movflags +faststart \\  
/home/ubuntu/eli_story_captioned.mp4
```

This recipe intentionally distinguishes between **what was generated**, **what was actually assembled into the MP4**, and **what was not done**. In particular, the music tracks were generated but no audio mix or audio mux was performed in the final video.